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Submitter Information

Name: Rhys Iliakis

Email: [REDACTED]

General Comment

AI, particularly generative AI, is deeply corrupting my work as a graphic artist/illustrator. Not only is it being pressed upon us on all sides, but it generates subpar “work” and scrapes from other artists to “learn.” Along with that, working artists have to now consistently vouch that their work is actually handmade and justify charging a livable wage for their work. I know this administration likely couldn’t care less about how important having a human eye and hand in creation of largely disseminated work, but as Marshall McLuhan said, “The medium is the message.” By forefronting and deregulating AI generation tools, the importance of craft and the livelihood of working artists is undercut.

Why is human-made art important and why should it be recognized as such? I’m a graphic artist, I work making art for a company and other small organizations on the side. I have developed an eye over years of work that no computer can replicate and few humans will notice unless I make an error. My work allows for ease of comprehension of complex topics, it processes them in my brain and translates them visually into a comprehensible form. An AI does not have the discretion to be aware of what baggage it was programmed with and will spit out uncritical images that can warp meaning. I can get deeper into the philosophy of this but that about sums it up.

But if you care more for the meat and potatoes: this is my career and I love doing it. I love working with small orgs for under what I would usually charge because I can make ends meet with my day job. If AI undercuts that and floods the market, people will notice something is off and feels artificial, they won’t like it, but they won’t necessarily know why. Art and design is made WITH humans in mind, AI does not care. But profit motives will push people to use it more and it will negatively affect my working relationships as I work slower than an AI (even if my product is better). I want to continue working to make people’s visual lives richer. AI slop is slop, but it’s cheap slop. Let’s put funding into real live human artists instead of more anti-human employee cutting measures.

AI needs to be deeply regulated to forefront human wellbeing, even at the cost of another country doing it better. The ONLY way this country can be great is ensuring the quality of life of ALL the citizens. AI has chipped away at quality of life and quality of work for several years now. I have seen it primarily used for scams and fraudulent businesses, on the art front. Regulation may slow “innovation” in some respects but it will encourage the AI makers to be more creative and ethical with their work instead of making it as fast as they can to amass wealth. This is technology we need to be careful with, for humanity’s sake.

Anyway, if this administration thinks AI can replace all “worthless” jobs like art, then maybe it could replace the whole executive branch. Just my two cents.